# Arbor

## Version Control System

User Manual

**Version 1.1**

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# Introduction

The Arbor Document Management System (DMS) is designed to help users create, manage, and control documents with version tracking and approval workflows.

The system ensures that only approved versions are active and accessible, while maintaining a complete history of all changes.

The application supports multiple user roles and provides a structured process for document creation, review, and approval.

# Section 1

## What's new?

In the newest version of the Arbor Document Management System – V1.1: We've introduced several improvements to enhance usability, accessibility, and overall user experience in Arbor Version Control System:

1. Modernized User Interface
   - The system now features a cleaner and more modern design, providing a more intuitive and visually appealing experience.

2. Light and Dark Theme Support
   - Users can now switch between light and dark themes, allowing for a more comfortable viewing experience based on personal preference. More information about it could be found on page 19.

3. Enhanced "Request a New Role" Functionality
   - A dropdown menu has been added to streamline the role request process and improve ease of use.

4. Improved Help Screen
   - The Help Screen has been upgraded to include a built-in User Manual, making it easier for users to find guidance and navigate the system.

## Section 2

## User Roles

The system defines four main user roles:

- **Author** – creates and edits documents and versions, and submits them for review;
- **Reviewer** – reviews document versions, approves or rejects them, and adds comments;
- **Reader** – has read-only access to active (approved) documents;
- **Administrator** – manages users, roles, and system configuration.

Each role has access only to specific functionalities based on permissions.

## Section 3

## Getting Started

To start using the system:

- Open the application.
- Enter your username and password on the login screen. If you don't have an account, you can create one by clicking on **Register**.
- Click the **Log in** button.
- After successful authentication, you will be redirected to the main dashboard.

Image No.1 – Startup Screen

# Section 4

# User Interface Overview

The system interface is designed as an intuitive graphical environment that allows users to easily navigate between documents, versions, and actions.

## 4.1 Login Screen

The login screen allows users to enter their credentials and access the system.

**Available actions:**

- Enter username
- Enter password
- Click **Log in**

Image No. 2 – Login Screen

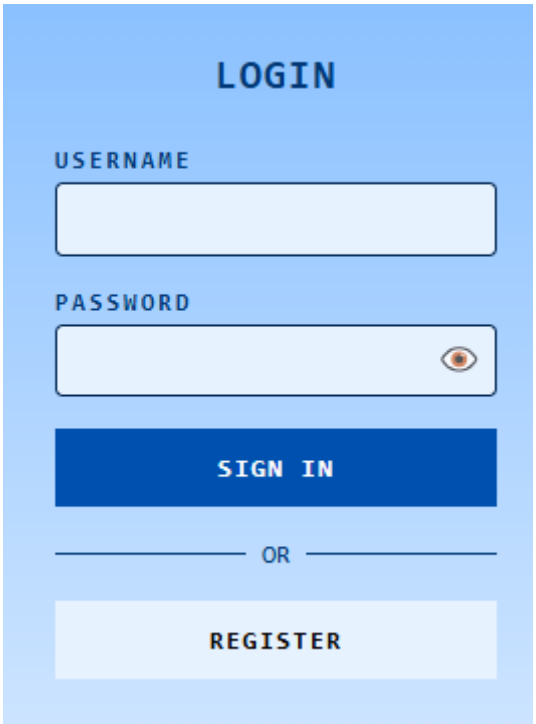


Image No. 3 – Login Section

## 4.2 Register Screen

The register screen allows users to enter credentials and create their own account to access the system.

**Available actions:**

- Enter username
- Enter password
- Confirm password by repeating it
- Choose a Role – Author, Reviewer or Reader
- Click **Sign Up**

At the bottom of the screen a message would appear, if the passwords do not match.

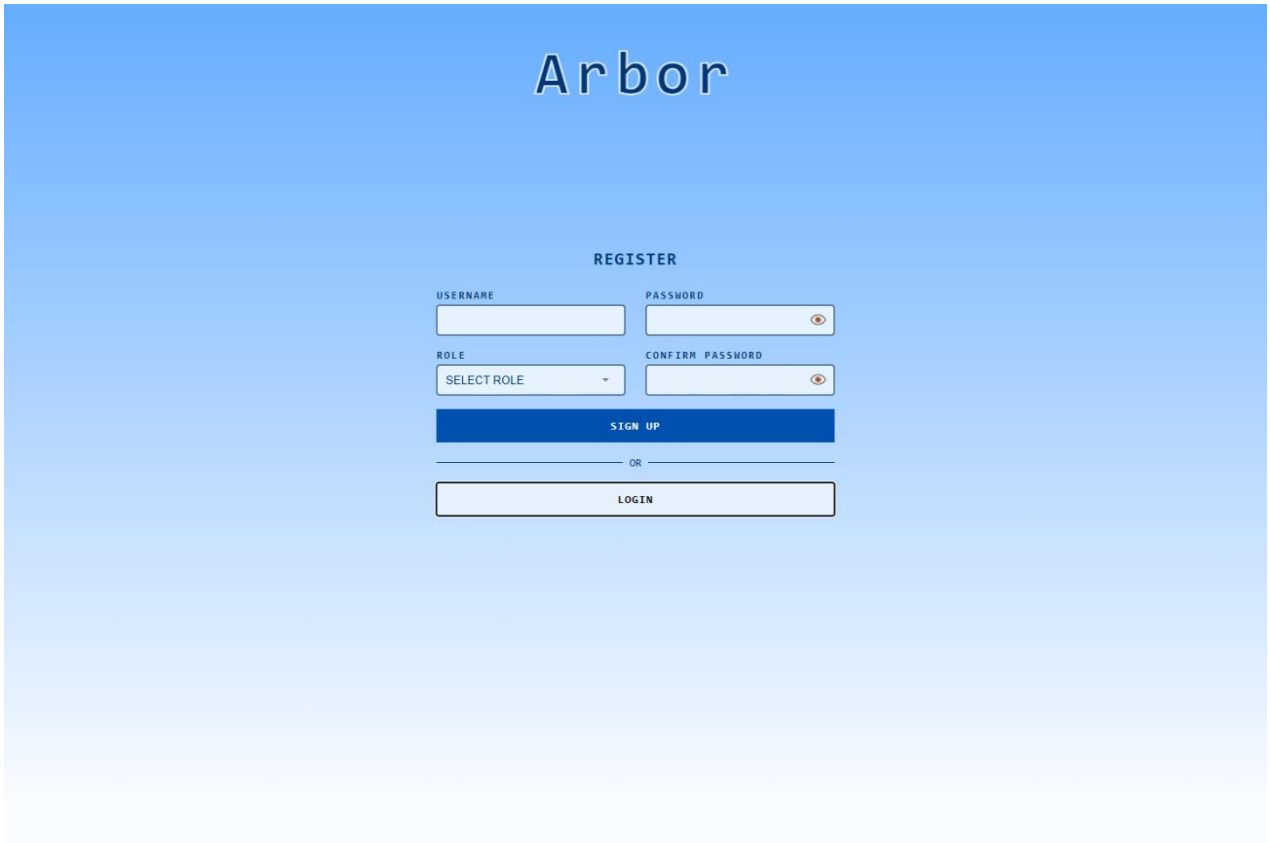


Image No. 4 – Register Screen

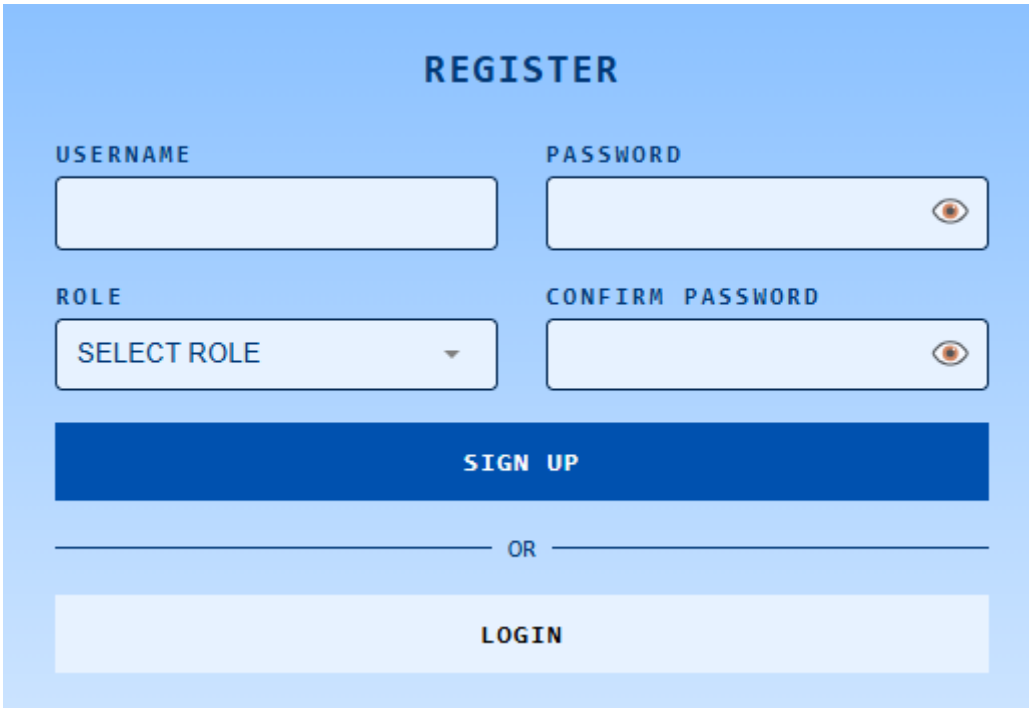


Image No. 5 – Register Section

## 4.3 Help Screen

This screen displays useful information about how the system operates and gives answer to the most frequently asked questions.

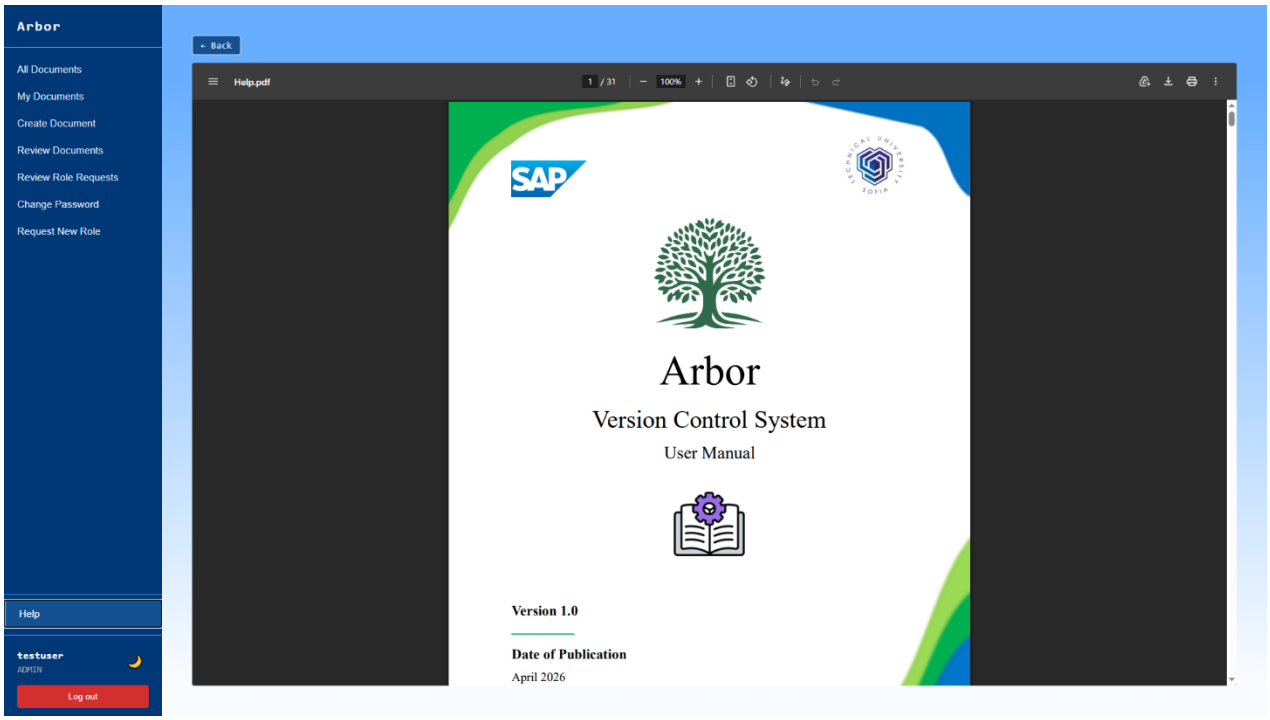


Image No. 6 - Help Screen

## 4.4 Dashboard

After logging in, users are redirected to the dashboard.

The dashboard provides access to:

- List of documents
- Request New Role – A choice between **Reader**, **Author** and **Reviewer**
- Change Password
- Log Out
- Navigation to different sections of the system

Based on the user's role the Dashboard Screen would look differently.

Image No.7 – Dashboard (General View)

## 4.5 Request A New Role Screen

This screen allows users to request a new role. They can choose between these options from the dropdown menu:

- Reader and Reviewer (if the current role is Author);
- Author and Reviewer (if the current role is Reader);
- Author and Reader (if the current role is Reviewer).

When the request is sent successfully, a message will appear at the bottom: “Request made successfully. Waiting for ADMIN’s approval”.

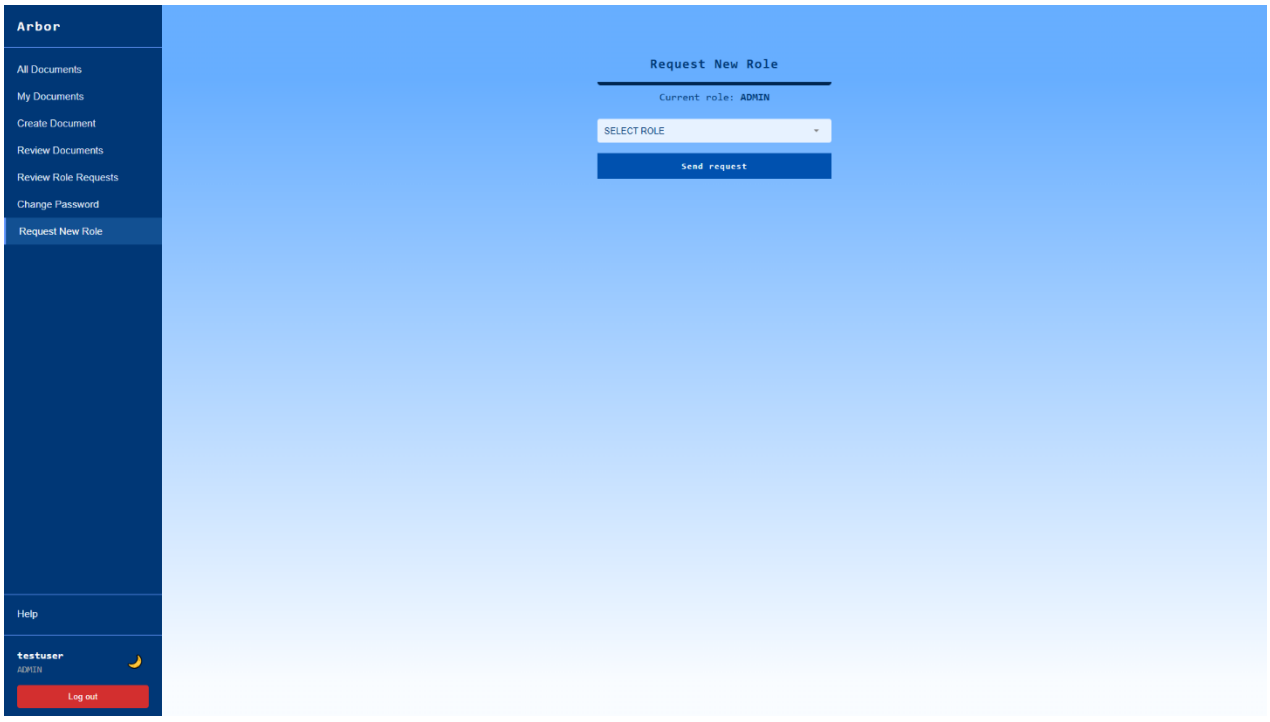


Image No. 8 – Request A New Role Screen

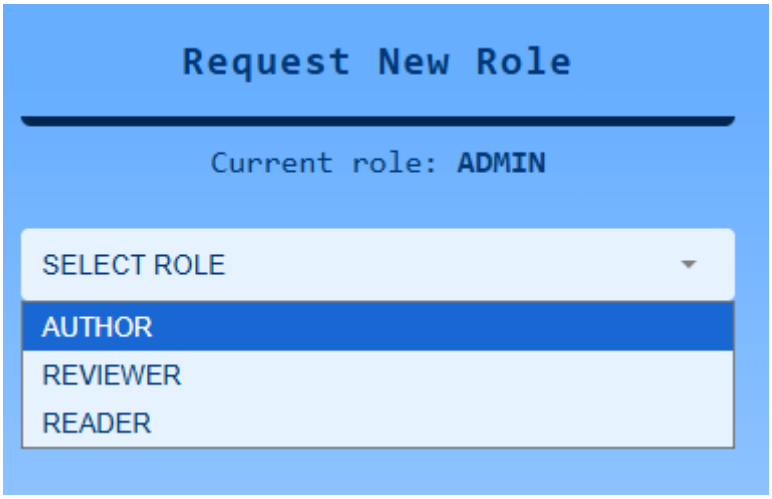


Image No. 9 – Dropdown Menu

## 4.6 Change Password Screen

This screen allows users to change their password. They need to enter the old password and then the new one.

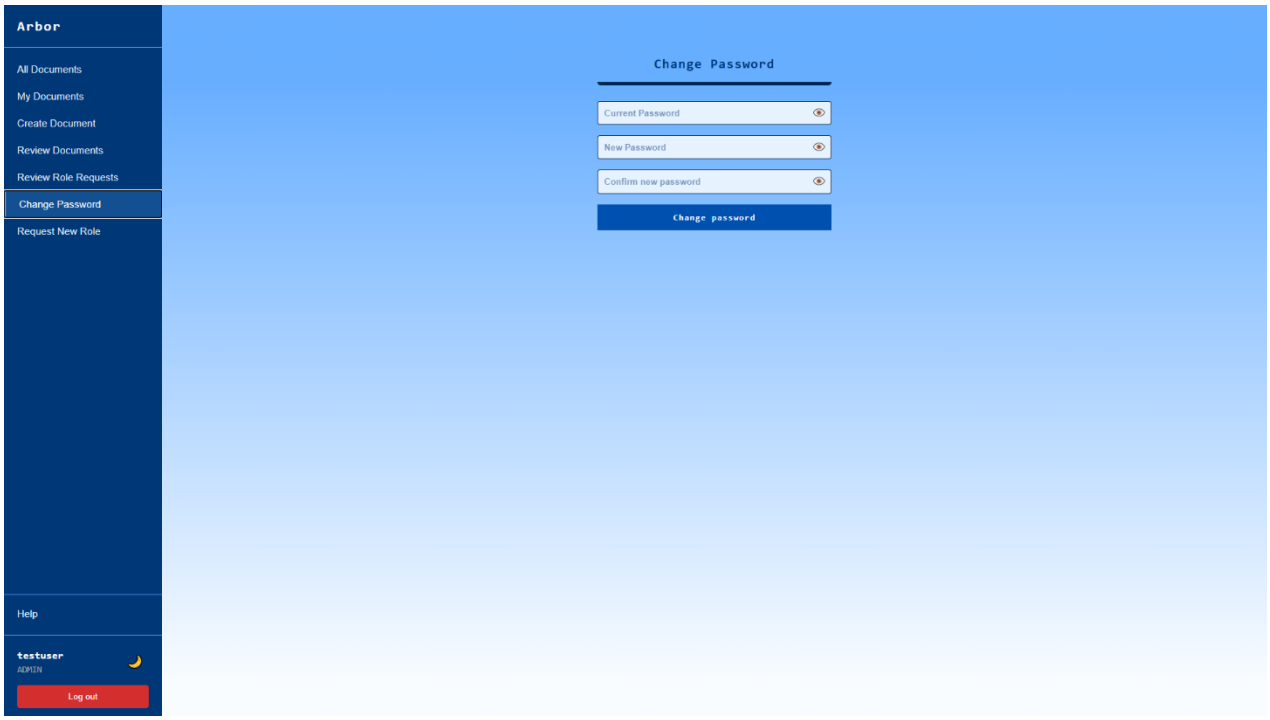


Image No. 10 – Change Password Screen

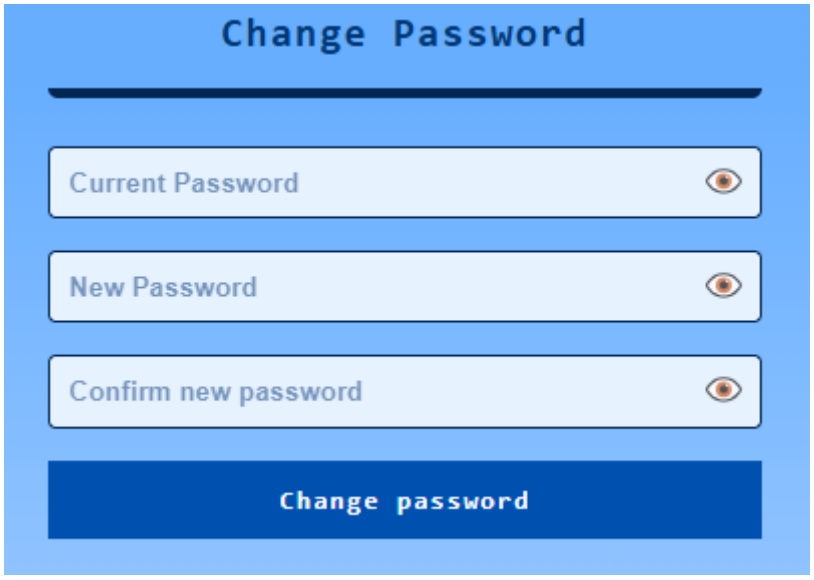


Image No. 11 – Change Password Section

## 4.7 Document List Screen

This screen displays all available documents in the system.

**Users can:**

- View document titles and basic information.
- Select a document to view details.
- Access the active version of a document.

If the list of documents is too big to be displayed all at once on the screen, there will be a scroll bar on the right side.

Image No.12 – Document List Screen

## 4.8 Document Details Screen

Displays detailed information about a selected document.

**Includes:**

- Document title and description
- List of all versions
- Status of each version
- Active version indicator

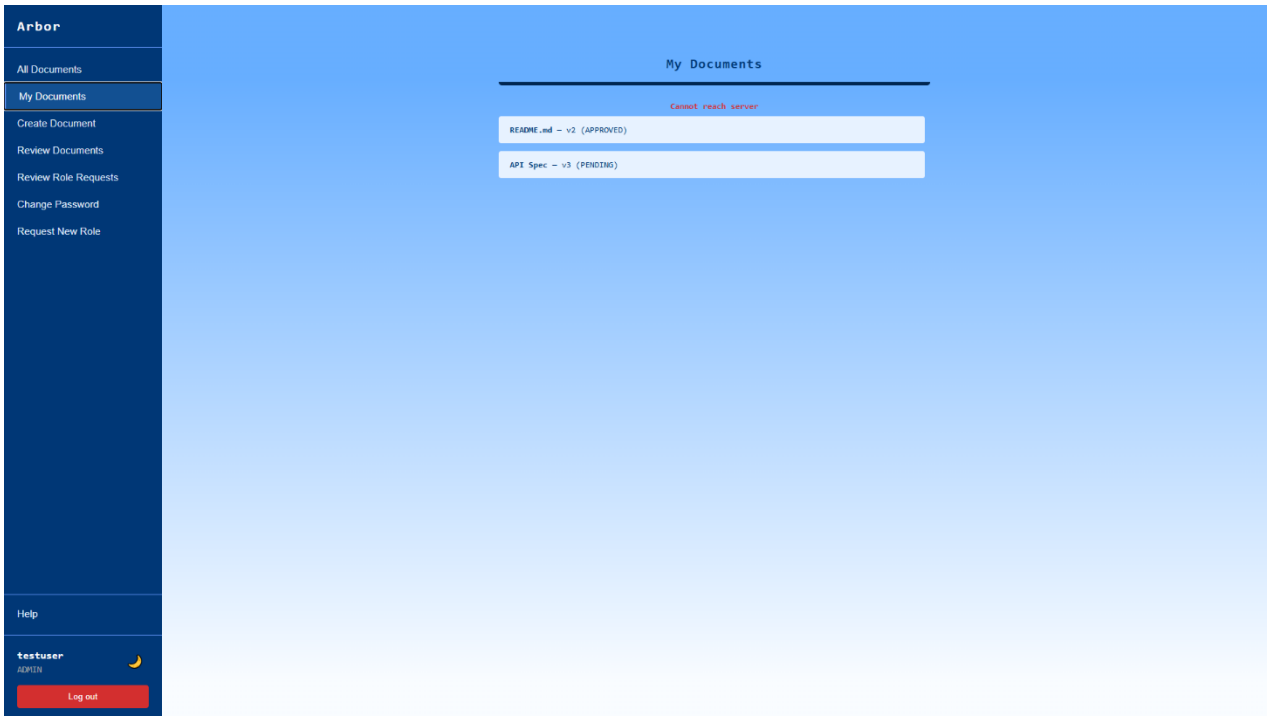


Image No. 13 – Document Details Screen

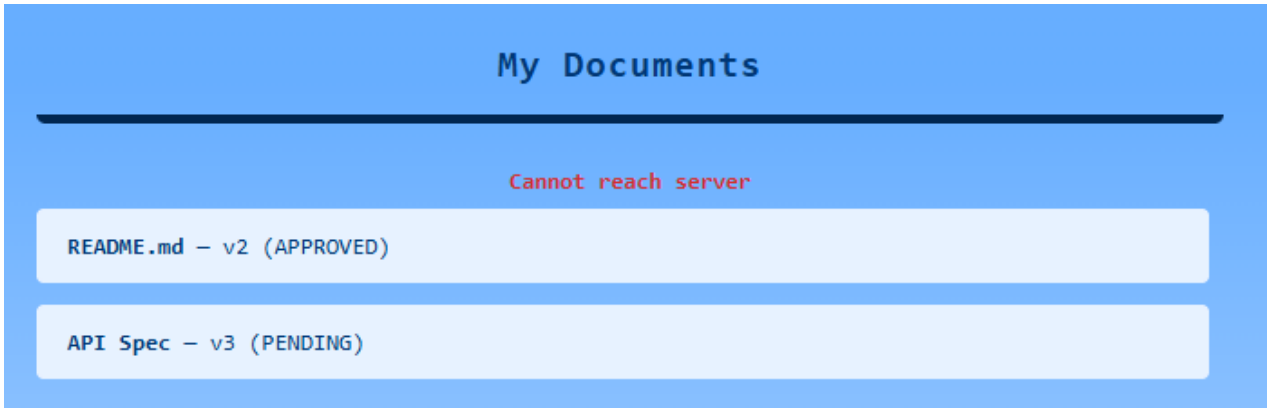


Image No. 14 – Documents and their Status

## 4.9 Version Management Screen

Allows users to create and manage document versions.

**Available actions:**

- Create a new version
- View version content
- Submit version for review
- Check version status

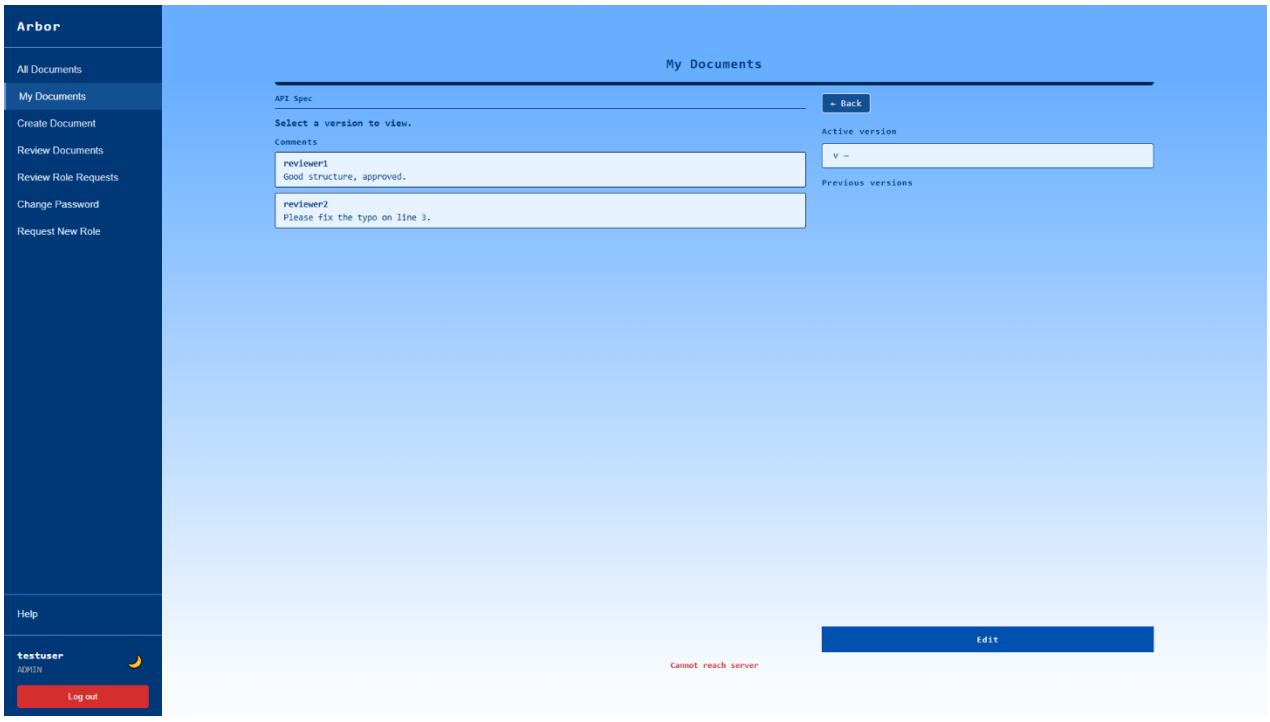


Image No. 15 – Version Management Screen

## 4.10 Review Screen

Used by reviewers to evaluate document versions.

## Available actions:

- Approve version
- Reject version
- Add comments

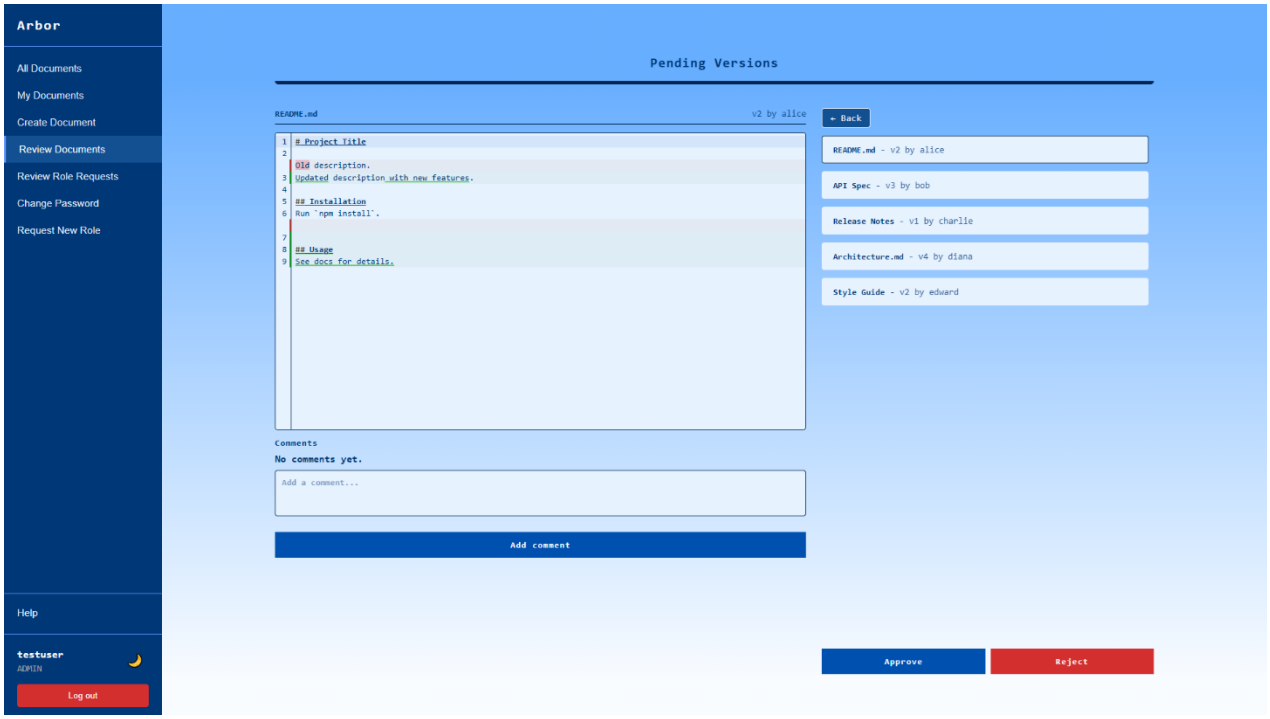


Image No. 16 – Review Screen

## 4.11 Light and Dark Theme

Users could witch between Light Theme (Sun Icon) or Dark Theme (Moon Icon) depending on their preferences. The icon is located on the top-right corner of the Startup Screen or at the bottom-left corner near the Help Section (Valid for every other Screen).

Image No. 17 - Sun Icon – Switch to Light Theme

Image No. 18 – Moon Icon – Switch to Dark Theme

# Section 5

# Main Functionalities

## 5.1 Author

Authors are responsible for creating and managing documents.

**Available actions:**

- Create a new document;
- Create a new version;
- Edit draft versions;
- Submit versions for review;
- View document history.

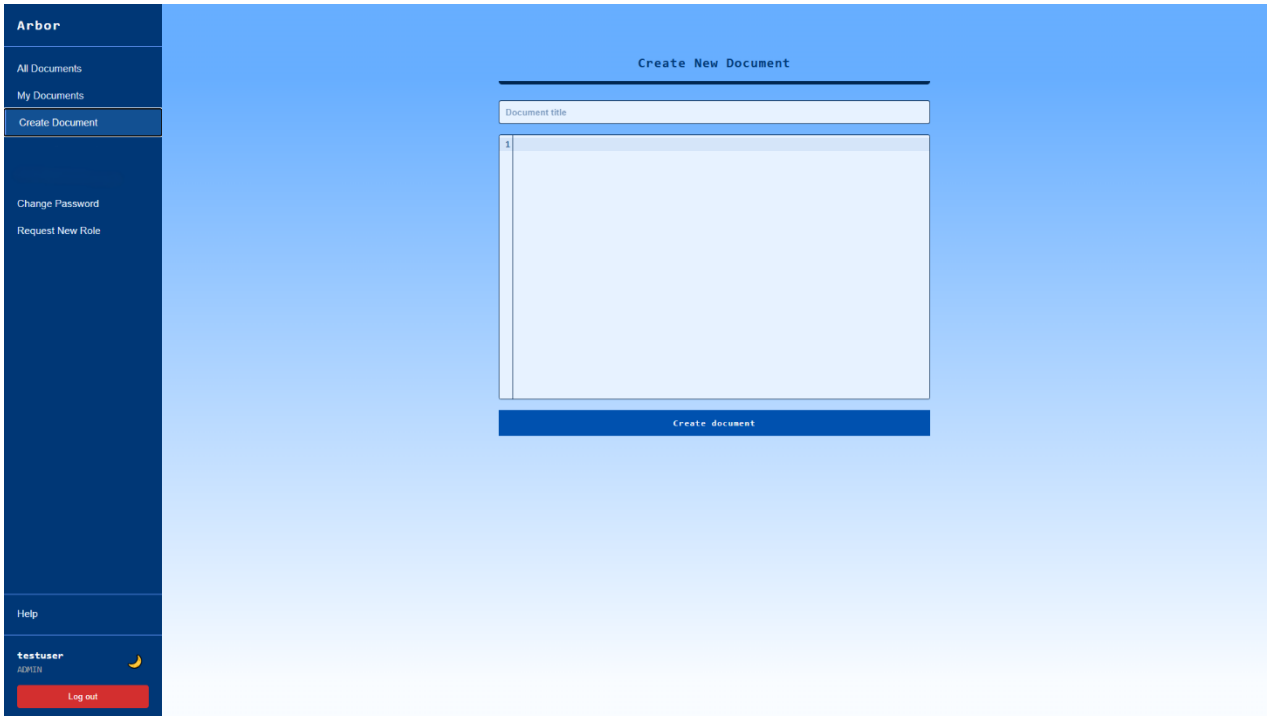


Image No. 19 – Create a New Document

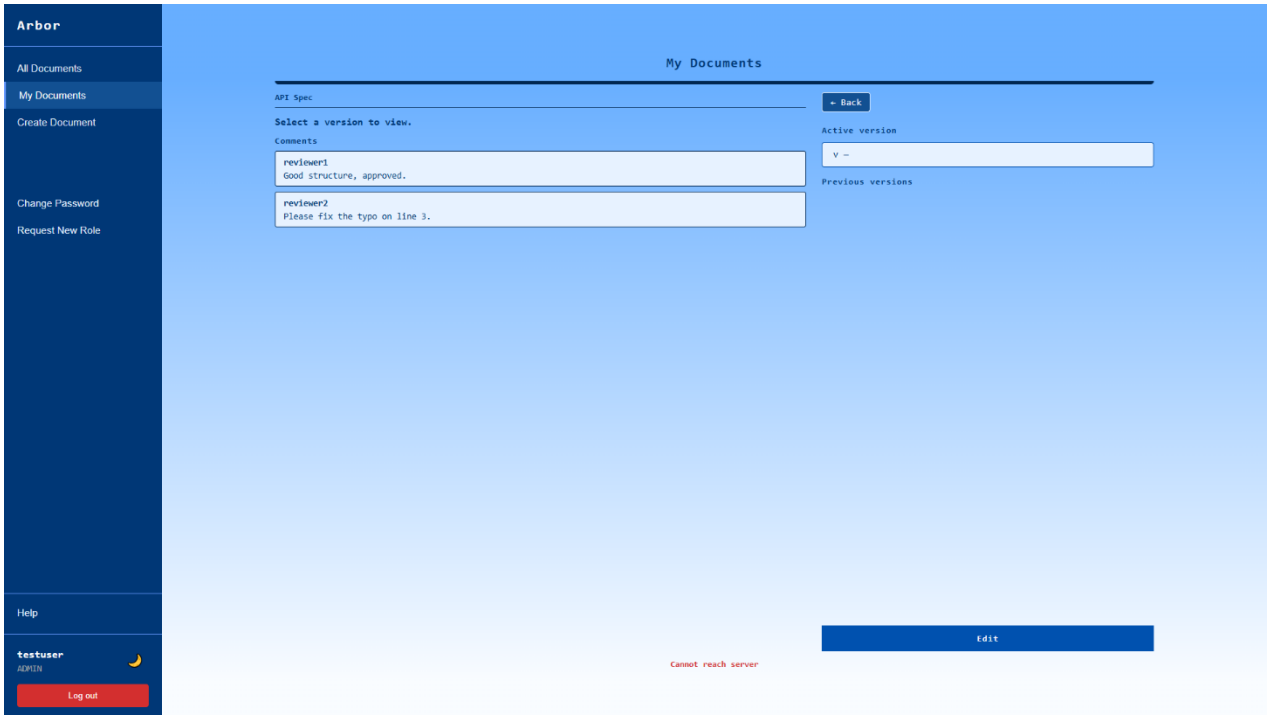


Image No. 20 – Editing Versions and Submitting Them for Review

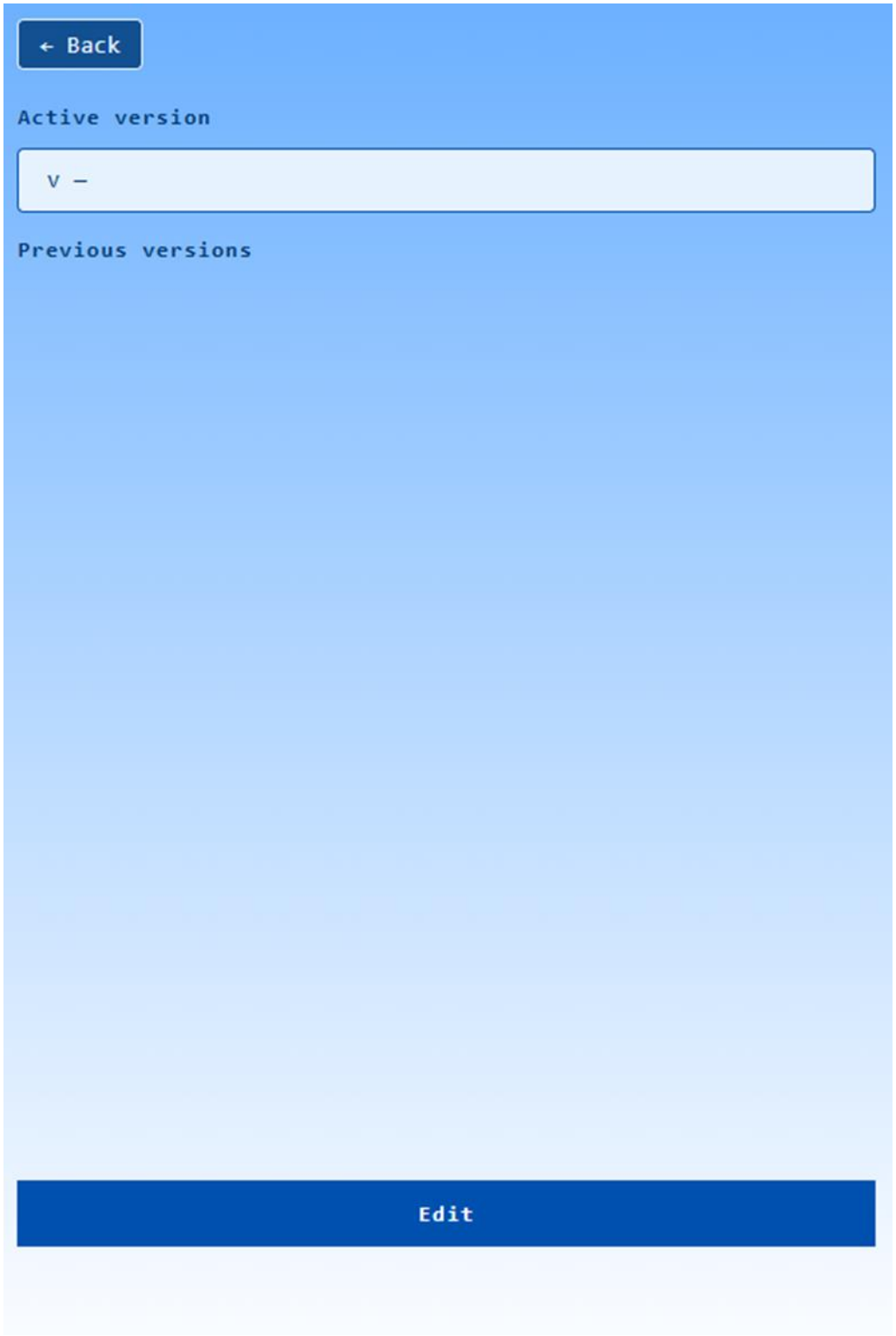


Image No. 21 – Versions Section and Edit Button

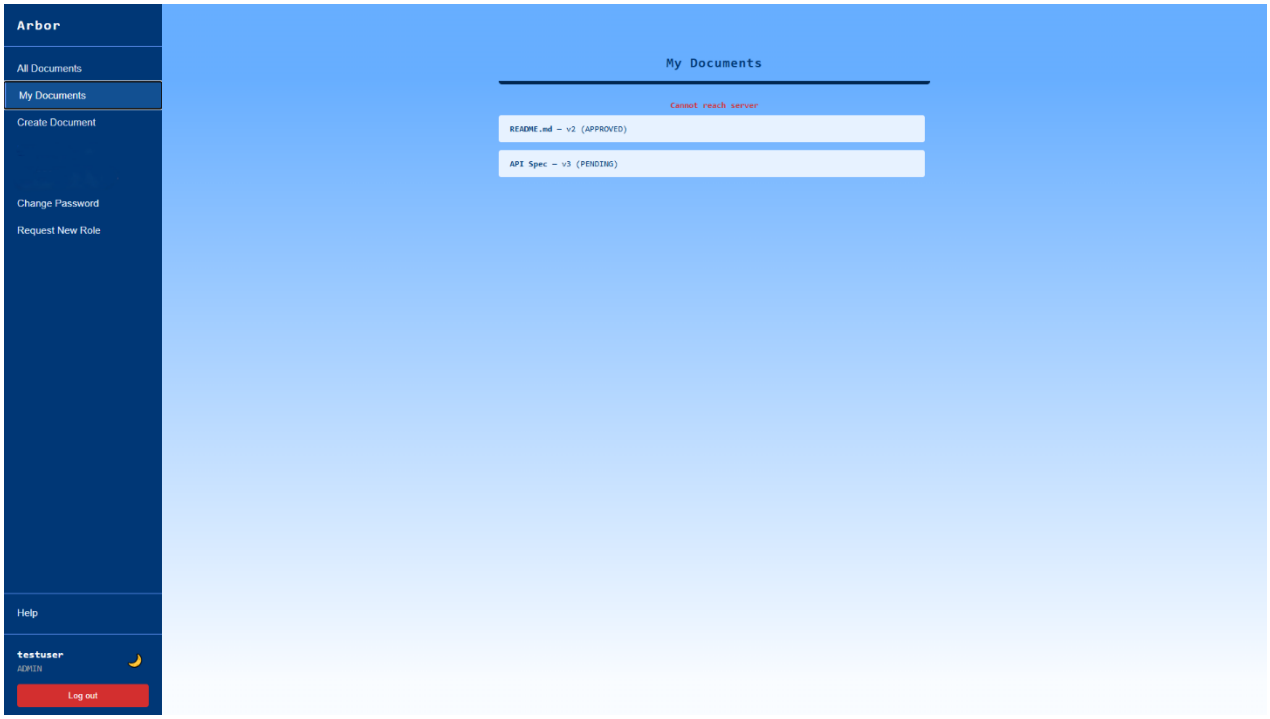


Image No. 22 – Document History

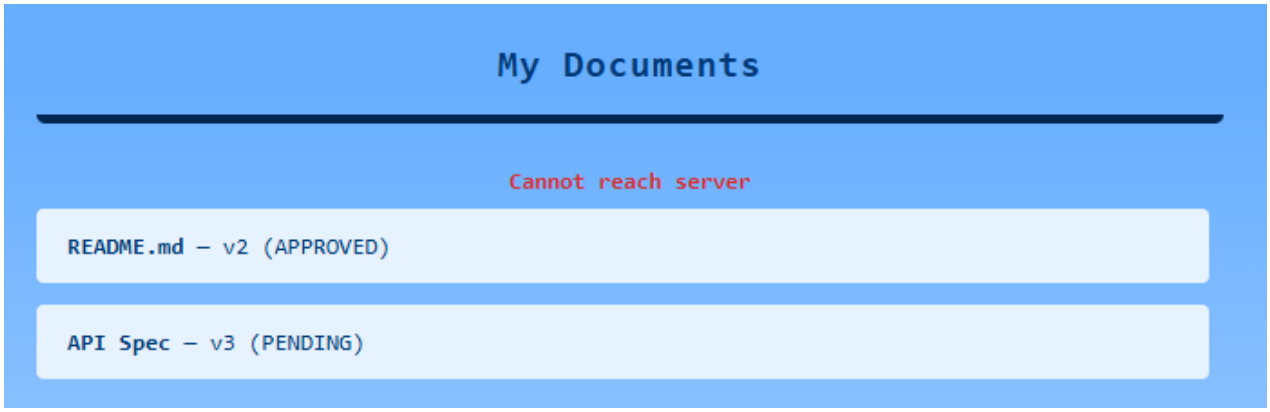


Image No. 23 – Documents and their Status

## 5.2 Reviewer

Reviewers validate document versions.

**Available actions:**

- Review submitted versions
- Approve versions
- Reject versions
- Add feedback/comments

Image No. 24 – List of Documents Pending Approval

The reviewed document disappears from the list.

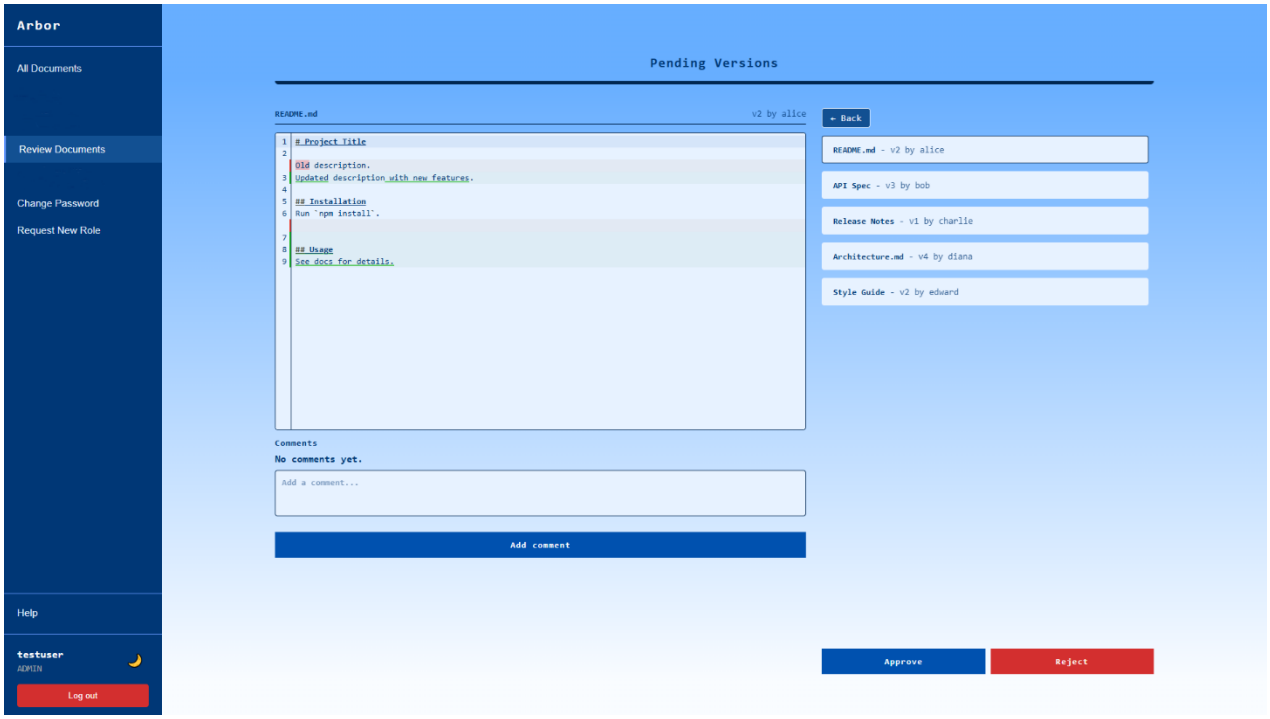


Image No. 25 – Document Version Evaluation

Image No. 26 – Section for Comments

Image No. 27 – Documents List and Action Buttons

## 5.3 Reader

Readers have read-only access.

**Available actions:**

- View documents
- View active versions

Image No. 28 – List of Active Versions of Documents

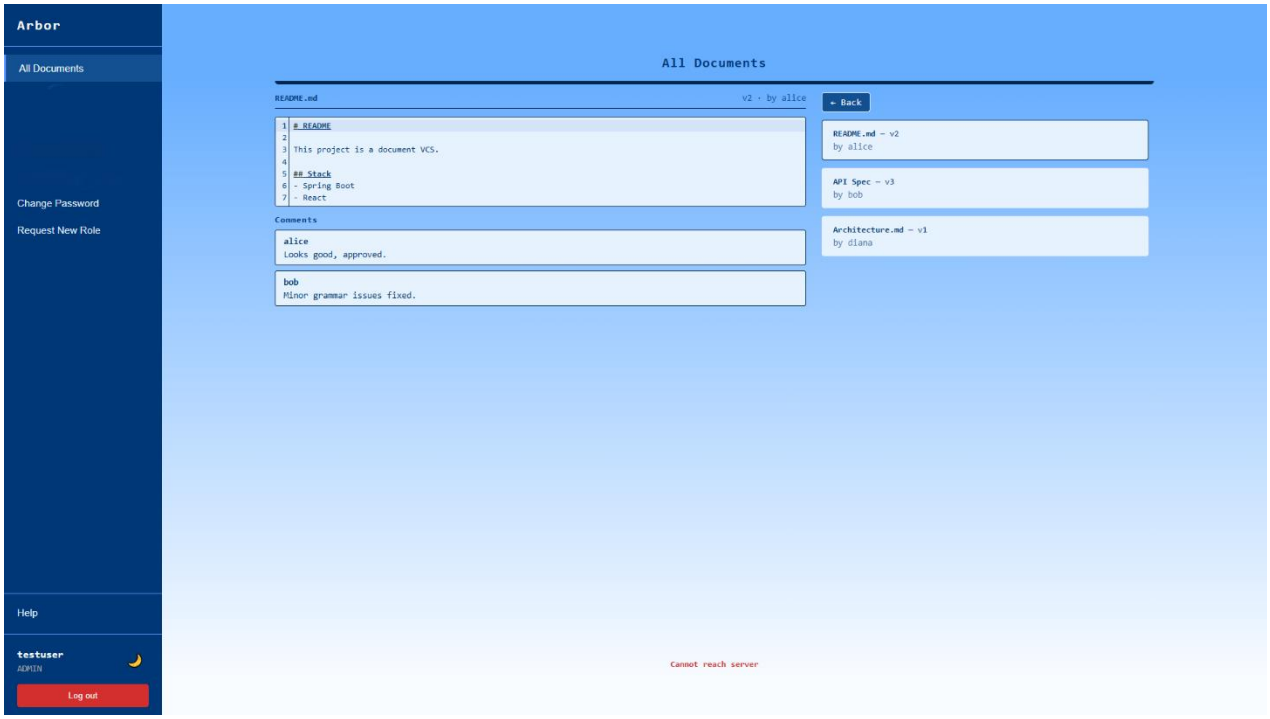


Image No. 29 – Document in Read Only Mode

## 5.4 Administrator

Administrators manage system configuration and have access to all functionalities of the product.

**Available actions:**

- Create users
- Assign roles
- Manage system settings

Image No. 30 – Review Role Requests Screen

Image No. 31 – List of Requests from Users

The reviewed requests disappear from the list.

Image No. 32 – Role Change

## Section 6

## Document Workflow

The system follows a structured lifecycle for document versions:

1. The Author creates a document
2. The Author creates a version (status: **DRAFT**)
3. The version is submitted for review (status: **UNDER_REVIEW**)
4. The Reviewer evaluates the version
5. The Reviewer either:

    - Approves it → status becomes **APPROVED**
    - Rejects it → status becomes **REJECTED**

6. Approved versions can be set as **ACTIVE**

Only active versions are visible to Readers.

## Section 7

## Version History

Each document maintains a complete history of its versions.

The history includes:

- Version identifier
- Author
- Creation date
- Status (DRAFT, UNDER_REVIEW, APPROVED, REJECTED, ACTIVE)

Users can review previous versions and track changes over time.

## Section 8

## Error Messages

The system provides clear feedback in case of invalid actions:

- **Access Denied** – insufficient permissions or wrong credentials
- **Document Not Found** – requested document does not exist
- **Invalid Version State** – action is not allowed in the current state
- **Missing Data** – required fields are not provided

## Section 9

## Additional Features (Optional)

Depending on implementation, the system may include:

- Version comparison (difference visualization)
- Notification system
- Audit log of user actions
- Export of documents to TXT or PDF

# Section 10

# Security

Arbor Version Control System uses **role-based access control (RBAC)**. This means that each operation checks the user's role before execution in order to minimise the probability of potential mistakes.

It is also strongly recommended using a more current version of the operating system (for example: Windows 10, Windows 11, macOS 15 Sequoia, mac OS 26 Tahoe, Linux Fedora 43, Linux Ubuntu 26.04, Linux Mint 22.3) for security purposes.

## Section 11

## Notes

- Only approved versions can become active.
- Rejected versions remain in history but cannot be activated.
- Each new version is based on the latest active version.
- All actions are controlled by user roles and permissions.
- The system interface is designed and prototyped using Figma. The prototype demonstrates the user flow and interaction between different system components.

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